PRACTICAL # 03

Setting the password

Linux Password setting

Type following passwd command to change your own password:

```
$ passwd
```

Sample Outputs:

```
Changing password for John
(current) UNIX password:
Enter new UNIX password:
Retype new UNIX password:
passwd: password updated successfully
```

The user is first prompted for his/her old password if one is present. This password is then encrypted and compared against the stored password. The user has only one chance to enter the correct password. As a general guideline, passwords should consist of 10 to 20 characters including one or more from each of following sets:

1. Lower case alphabetics
2. Upper case alphabetics
3. Digits 0 thru 9
4. Punctuation marks/spacial characters

Linux change password for other user account

You need to login as the root user, type the following command to change password for user John,

```
# passwd John
```

OR

```
$ sudo passwd John
```

Where,

- John – is username or account name.

Passwords do not display to the screen when you enter them. For example:
Linux changing user password using passwd.

Changing user passwords on Linux

As a Linux system administrator (sysadmin) you can change password for any users on your server. To change a password on behalf of a user:

1. First sign on or “su” or “sudo” to the “root” account on Linux, run: sudo -i
2. Then type ”passwd tom” to change a password for tom user
3. The system will prompt you to enter a password twice

Conclusion:

The passwd command line utility is used to update or change user’s password. The encrypted password is stored in /etc/shadow file and account information is in /etc/passwd file.